STANDARD IX ENGLISH
UNIT 02: WINDS OF CHANGE
CHAPTER : TOILET

Gcina Mhlope is totally shattered when her sister rebuked her.Pepare her diary.

Monday

10.pm

Oh ! What a fateful day! Life had been too tough on me. I don't have any idea if there is anything I could do to make myself a little more comfortable. It was really tough staying with my sister, though I managed to get a job. My days were getting tougher and tougher. I have to stay with her hiding myself from others. I have to get up early and sneak to the gate tip toeing so that none of them notice my presence there. My bus would come by 7.30 and that means I have two hours in my hand. I must find some place as the weather is too hostile. I spotted the public toilet and that is where I decided to spend my time reading magazines and some times dreaming. But today after my work I was waiting for my sister. She had been delayed somewhere .Hence I sat down in front of her room thinking that no one would notice. But the cursed dogs came sniffing for me. Seeing me , a stranger there ,they started barking at me like anything. I was scared to death. The landlady came rushing in.She never expected me there. Somehow I lied to her. But when my sister came, she was furious and she rebuked me for sitting there. For a while she didn't speak to me.On our way home ,I felt like crying. I felt abandoned and orphaned. I really longed for someone who could tell me that I was not an unwanted person, that I was also worthy, that my sister didn't hate me, that I also would get a better place to live, that someday my dreams also would come true. I was shattered beyond means and my mind was all in tears .Oh, God please help me recover from this pain, please help me come out of this disappointment.

Gcina Mhlope was rebuked by her sister as she was spotted by the landlady . Prepare a conversation between them.

Sister.Gcina,what are you doing outside in the street?

Gcina .I was waiting for you.

Sister. How many times I warned you not to get noticed ?

Gcina. I thought they would not notice me.

Sister. Don't you have any idea how hard it will become ,if they know you are with me?

Gcina. I know

Sister. You could have waited somewhere else.

Gcina. I am sorry.

Sister. My life is already a real hell .Don't 't add up more troubles.

Gcina. I wish I were no burden to you.

Sister. You aren't. But be careful.

Gcina. I never meant to put you in trouble.

Sister. You may be right .But these people are unforgiving.

Gcina. I understand.

Sister. I have no idea what they will do if they see you again.

Gcina. I will take utmost care to hide myself from them.

Prepare a write up on how personal struggles shape our future based on the reading of the story, 'The Toilet' .

Personal struggles enable one to appreciate and face the challenges that life throws in a better way. The hardships and difficulties help one to have a stronger mind and still stronger determination to reach one's ambitions .Some. One who is sitting in the comfort of his home would never feel prompted for daring steps. One has to break the shell of his comfort zone and embrace struggles to become exposed to hard changes. Just like the metal gold which turns brighter at each of the blow it receives, people who suffer hardships tend to become more successful than others. They acquire one of the greatest skills to success i.e.perseverence. Things would turn up at the right time ,to the right person at the right person. For this to become possible one needs a huge amount of patience. The stories of all great men prove that they never had a flower strewn path.Instead they had had struggles hardships difficulties and obstacles which they faced bravely to reach their goals. Only true success lasts for ever which is achieved through dedication, sacrifice, perseverance, and hard work. In the story The Toilet,Gcina Mhlope talks about her imposed seclusion as she had no means of living other than with her sister. She was forced to live hiding herself from the others as if she doesn't exist. But her imposed seclusion turns to be a blessing in disguise. The time she spend in the public toilet helped her to have lot of private time .she started writing what she felt then. She was gradually turning to be a great story teller. She had only adverse life situations. She faced loneliness, seclusion. She felt orphaned. Life had been too tough to her. She had to wake up early way before the others and tip toe to the gate and move stealthily so that nobody notices her presence. She then had to spend hours in the public toilet to keep herself safe from the unfriendly weather .But as days passed by ,she got used to sitting in the toilet reading books or writing something.

She then realised that this moments could be used productively. It was then she started writing, a means to fight all the insecurities in her life. And it is no exaggeration to say that she has won the battle of her life. She became a renowned writer.The struggles of her life, her resilience, her perseverance, her sacrifice, her anxieties and fear, her brave steps and her strong determination helped her to reach the heights she always dreamt of.

Prepare the profile of Gcina Mhlope.

Birth: October 24,1958

Place :Kwa ZULU, South Africa

Career: Anti apartheid activist, actress, story teller, playwright, poet, director, author.

Major work. Black dog.Injemnyama

Award.Obie award for performance.

GCINA MHLOPE

Gcina Mhlope is a South African writer cum anti apartheid activist. She was born in Kwa ZULU, South Africa on 24 October in the year 1958 .She was a renowned poet, an author, a story teller, an actress and a play wright. Blackdog;injemnyama is her major work. She was rewarded with Obie award for performance.

Prepare a questionnaire to be asked to Gcina Mhlope.

What is that one struggle in life that helped you to become stronger?

Do you think perseverance is a stronger quality to achieve success?

How far does struggles and hardships become instrumental in shaping one's future?

What did you feel ,once you are done with your insecurities?

What is the best advice life has given you?

If you could leave a message in one sentence for the young,what would it be?